AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

TR103
Contrastive Analysis

Main
MTA

2025-2026 /Fall
Date:19/11/2025

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 1.5 hours**

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Read the questions carefully before you answer.
2. Answer all the questions in the answer booklet clearly.
3. Write all your answers in ink NOT pencil.
4. Edit and proofread your language.
5. No dictionaries are allowed.

CamScanner

Question 1: Short Notes (5 marks: 15 minutes)

In 60-80 words, explain the key differences between propositional meaning and expressive meaning in language. Your answer must include one specific example for each type of meaning.

Question 2: Strategy Identification (5 marks: 10 minutes)

Identify and name the strategy used by the translator to achieve equivalence for the underlined words. (2.5 marks each)

	ST	TT
1.	Throughout the north frozen soils thaw, releasing methane	في كل أرجاء الشمال، ستذوب التربة المتجمدة وستطلق غاز الميثان.
2.	إصدار الفتاوى عملٌ شاقٌ يتطلب علما وورعا كبيرين.	Issuing religious opinions is an arduous task that requires profound knowledge and great piety.

Question 3: Error Identification and Correction (5 marks: 20 minutes)

Read the excerpt below and its translation and answer the questions which follow.

ST	TT
The negotiations hit a brick wall over the issue of intellectual property. It was a real Catch-22*. *slang for an impossible situation	اصطدمت المفاوضات بجدار من الطوب حول قضية الملكية الفكرية. لقد كانت قبضة 22 حقيقية.

1. **Identify and name the TWO distinct types of translation errors evident in the target text (TT). (2 marks: 1 mark for identifying each error)**
2. **Provide a correct Arabic translation for the entire sentence. (3 marks for a correct, idiomatic translation)**

CamScanner

Question 4: Critical Reflection (10 marks: 45 minutes)

Read the English translation below for the Arabic news on elections in Iraq and write a critical reflection of 120-150 words drawing on your understanding of Baker's (2018) concept of grammatical equivalence. In your reflection, discuss the strategies and techniques the translator used to overcome non-equivalence on the grammatical level.

ST	TT
تكتسب الانتخابات العراقية أهمية استثنائية. ففي ظل تشابك مصالح القوى الإقليمية والدولية داخل الساحة العراقية، تصبح العملية الانتخابية أكثر من مجرد استحقاق دستوري، بل أداة لفرز مواقف سياسية قد تحدد شكل تموضع العراق في ملفات إقليمية حساسة، لا سيما فيما يتعلق بالفصائل المسلحة التي ترتبط بشكل أو بآخر بمحاور خارجية. وحذرت أطراف سياسية من أن تأجيل أو إلغاء الانتخابات قد يفتح الباب أمام فراغ دستوري، ويزيد من احتمالات الفوضى السياسية والأمنية. وفي هذا السياق، أكد زعيم ائتلاف دولة القانون، ورئيس الوزراء الأسبق نوري المالكي، أن إجراء الانتخابات في موعدها يشكل ضرورة وطنية لحماية الاستقرار، والحفاظ على المسار الديمقراطي في البلاد. Source: https://www.bbc.com/arabic/articles/cgr40824pk2o	The Iraqi elections are gaining exceptional significance. Amid the intertwined interests of regional and international powers within the Iraqi arena, the electoral process transcends being merely a constitutional requirement—it has become an instrument for sorting out political stances that could determine Iraq's positioning on sensitive regional issues, particularly concerning armed factions linked in one way or another to external axes. Political factions have warned that postponing or canceling the elections could lead to a constitutional vacuum and increase the likelihood of political and security chaos. In this context, the leader of the State of Law Coalition and former Prime Minister Nouri al-Maliki emphasized that holding the elections on time is a national necessity to protect stability and preserve the country's democratic path.

End of Exam!

Best Wishes ☺

CamScanner